# सहायक प्राध्यापक (मार्केटिंग), महाराष्ट्र शिक्षण सेवा, गट-अ
**(महाविद्यालयीन शाखा)**
**उच्च व तंत्र शिक्षण विभाग**
# Assistant Professor (Marketing), Maharashtra Education Service, Group-A
**(Collegiate Branch)**
**Higher and Technical Education Department**

**परीक्षेचे टप्पे:** **१)** लेखी परीक्षा - २०० गुण **२)** मुलाखत- ५० गुण

## -: परीक्षा योजना :-

| विषय व सांकेतांक | माध्यम | प्रश्नसंख्या | गुण | कालावधी | दर्जा | प्रश्नपत्रिकेचे स्वरुप |
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| विषयांशी संबंधीत घटक (११५३) | इंग्रजी | १०० | २०० | एक तास | पदव्युत्तर पदवी | वस्तुनिष्ठ बहुपर्यायी |

**अ) नकारात्मक गुणदान -**

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| १) प्रत्येक चुकीच्या उत्तराकरीता २५% किंवा १/४ एवढे गुण एकूण गुणांमधून वजा/ कमी करण्यात येतील. |
| २) एखाद्या प्रश्नाची एकापेक्षा अधिक उत्तरे दिली असल्यास अथवा ज्या उमेदवाराने उत्तरपत्रिकेत पूर्ण वर्तुळ चिन्हांकित केले नसेल अशा प्रश्नाचे उत्तर चुकीचे समजण्यात येऊन त्या प्रश्नाच्या उत्तराकरीता २५% किंवा १/४ एवढे गुण एकूण गुणांमधून वजा/कमी करण्यात येतील. |
| ३) वरीलप्रमाणे कार्यपध्दतीचा अवलंब करताना एकूण अंतिम गुणांची बेरीज अपूर्णांकात आली तरीही ती अपूर्णांकातच राहील व पुढील कार्यवाही त्याच्या आधारे करण्यात येईल. |
| ४) एखाद्या प्रश्नाचे उत्तर अनुत्तरित असेल तर, अशा प्रकरणी नकारात्मक गुणांची पध्दत लागू असणार नाही. |

**ब) अंतिम गुणवत्ता यादी ही वस्तुनिष्ठ परीक्षेतील व मुलाखतीतील एकत्रित गुणांवर आधारीत राहील.**

## -: अभ्यासक्रम :-

**विषयांशी संबंधित घटक यामध्ये खालील घटक व उपघटकांचा समावेश असेल.**

| अ.क्र. | घटक व उपघटक |
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| 1 | **Basics of Marketing**<br><br>Marketing - Definition, Evolution, core concepts, Marketing v/s Selling, Role of a Marketing Manager in the current scenario, Marketing Environment – Internal and External Environment. Marketing Mix elements; Marketing Process.<br><br>Market segmentation, Meaning, its benefits, Bases for segmenting Consumer market and Industrial market, Market Targeting, Patterns of Targeting, Product positioning concept Positioning strategies.<br><br>Concept, Levels of Products – core benefit, basic product, expected product, augmented product and potential product, Product Life Cycle - concept, stages.<br><br>Pricing: Meaning, Objectives, Pricing Strategies - Skimming pricing, Penetration pricing and psychological pricing.<br><br>Place-Need and importance of distribution, Factors influencing selection of distribution channel, Channels of Distribution. Elements of Promotional Mix- Advertising, Publicity, Public Relations, Sales Promotion, Personal Selling and Direct Marketing.<br><br>Green Marketing - Meaning, Importance, Use of Information Technology in marketing practices – Virtual marketing, E-buying behavior. Digital Marketing- Meaning and Importance. |
| 2 | **Marketing Research**<br><br>Introduction to Marketing Research-Importance of marketing research in business decision-making, Overview of Marketing Research- Evolution, purpose, and scope, Ethics in Marketing Research: Transparency and data privacy concerns, Current Trends: Rise of AI, Big Data Analytics. |

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| | Problem Formulation- Identifying and defining the research problem. Research Design: Exploratory, descriptive, and causal research approaches. Real-time data collection and crowdsourced research methods.<br><br>Qualitative Research Techniques- In-depth interviews, focus groups, ethnographic research. Emerging Tools- Online communities and AI-assisted sentiment analysis, social media and neuro-marketing techniques.<br><br>Research Tools & Techniques- Factor Analysis, Multi-Dimensional Scaling (MDS), Conjoint Analysis, Discriminant Analysis, Cluster Analysis, Automation in data processing, predictive analytics, use of visualization tools like Tableau and Power BI.<br><br>Applications of Marketing Research- Segmenting and Positioning, New Product Development, Pricing Research, Media Research, Application of machine learning for forecasting and scenario analysis. |
| **3** | **Product Management**<br><br>Introduction to Product Management: Product Concept, Types of Products, Product Line, Line Extension Product Mix Decisions,<br><br>Developing product strategies aligned with business goals, conducting market research to identify target markets, Conducting competitive analysis and positioning<br><br>Product Life Cycle- Identify the phases in the Product Life Cycle, Managing products throughout their lifecycle, Growth strategies and expansion opportunities, Ansoff Matrix.<br><br>New Product Decisions: Types of New Products, New Product Development Process, Design Thinking process, Adoption of New Products.<br><br>Packaging- Purpose, Types and new trends in packaging.<br><br>Pricing Decisions: Factors influencing pricing decisions, pricing strategies, Setting the Price and Managing the price Change. Pricing considerations for different markets and customer segments |
| **4** | **Consumer Behaviour**<br><br>Foundations of Consumer Behavior- Definition and importance of consumer behaviour, Historical Evolution of Consumer Behavior Theories, Consumer Behavior in a Digital-First World,Behavioural Segmentation i.e. Psychographics, Geographics, and Technographics<br><br>Psychological Factors Influencing Consumer Behavior-Consumer Perception, Learning, and Memory in Marketing, Motivation and Personality Theories, Emotions.<br><br>Social, Cultural and Environmental Influences-Influence of Social Groups, Family, and Reference Groups, Role of Culture, Subculture, and Social Class, Impact of social media and Influencers on Consumer Behavior, Building Brand Loyalty in a Competitive Market<br><br>Consumer Decision-Making Process- Problem Recognition and Information Search, Evaluation of Alternatives and Purchase Decision, Post-Purchase Behavior and Customer Satisfaction, Role of Digital Touchpoints in Consumer Journey<br><br>Digital Transformation in Consumer Behavior- consumer behaviour in E-commerce, Mobile Commerce, and Social Commerce, Personalization using AI and Machine Learning, Role of Augmented Reality (AR) and Virtual Reality (VR) in Consumer Experience, Data Privacy and Ethical Issues in Consumer Behavior, Customer Retention Strategies in Digital Marketing<br><br>Consumer Analytics- Tools for Consumer Data Collection: Surveys, Focus Groups, Social Listening, Predictive Analytics and Big Data in Understanding Consumer Trends<br><br>Emerging Trends in Consumer Behavior- Role of Virtual Influencers in Shaping Consumer Preferences, Consumer Behavior in Gen Z and Millennial Markets |

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| 5 | **Customer Relationship Management**<br><br>Introduction to CRM**:** Definition and Evolution of CRM, Types of CRM: Operational, Analytical, Collaborative Importance of CRM in the Digital Age, Role of CRM in Customer Lifecycle.<br><br>Customer-Centric Business Strategies**:** Understanding Customer Needs and Expectations, Building Customer Loyalty and Retention Strategies, Creating Value through Personalized Experiences<br><br>Technology in CRM-Overview of CRM Tools and Platforms (e.g., Sales force, Hub Spot),Role of Big Data and Analytics in CRM, AI and Machine Learning in CRM- Predictive Analytics and Chat bots, Customer Data Privacy and Ethical Considerations<br><br>Customer Segmentation and Analytics**-** Methods for Customer Segmentation (Demographic, Behavioural, Psychographic), Analyzing Customer Data for Insights, Key Metrics: Customer Lifetime Value (CLV), Customer Satisfaction (CSAT), Net Promoter Score (NPS), Real-Life Application of Customer Insights.<br><br>Current Trends in CRM-Omni channel CRM and Integration, Mobile CRM and Social CRM, Role of IoT in Enhancing Customer Experiences, Gamification in CRM Strategies.<br><br>Implementing and Managing CRM**-**CRM Implementation Challenges and Solutions, Aligning CRM with Organizational Goals, Training and Change Management for CRM Systems, Measuring CRM Effectiveness: KPIs and ROI.<br><br>CRM in Industry Contexts**-** CRM in Retail, Banking, Healthcare, and Hospitality, B2B vs. B2C CRM Strategies, Role of CRM in E-commerce and Digital Marketing<br><br>Future of CRM**-** Emerging Technologies in CRM- Block chain, Metaverse, Hyper-Personalization and Predictive Engagement, Sustainable and Ethical CRM Practices. |
| 6 | **Sales management**<br><br>Introduction to Sales Management- Role and Importance of Sales Management, types of Sales Organizations: B2B, B2C, D2C, Key Skills of a Sales Manager<br><br>Sales Planning and Strategy- Sales Forecasting Techniques, Territory Management and Sales Quotas, Designing and Managing Sales Budgets<br><br>Managing the Sales Team-Recruitment and Selection of Sales Professionals, Training and Development Programs, Performance Appraisal and Motivation, Sales Compensation Plans<br><br>Sales Approaches- Consultative Selling, Solution Selling, SPIN Selling (Situation, Problem, Implication, Need), Challenger Sales Model<br><br>Sales Technology and Tools- Sales Force Automation Tools, AI in Sales: Chatbots, Predictive Analytics, Digital Sales Platforms, E-commerce and Social platform Selling<br><br>Legal and Ethical Issues in Sales: Ethical Selling Practices, Regulatory Compliance (GDPR, Consumer Protection Laws), Managing Conflicts of Interest<br><br>Emerging Trends in Sales Management- Behavioural Sales Insights, Virtual Reality (VR) in Sales, Influencer Marketing in Sales Demonstrations, Sales in the Metaverse. |
| 7 | **Services Marketing**<br>Service Industry- Growth in services sector, Nature of Services, Marketing Mix for Services, Importance of Services Marketing.<br><br>Unique Characteristics of services- Intangibility, Inseparability, Heterogeneity, Perish ability of services. Demand variation and capacity constraints, measures to respond to changes in demand. Strategies to manage Perishability Intangibility, Inseparability and Heterogeneity. Consumer Behavior in services. |

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| | Designing the service enterprise- new service development, developing a Service blueprint, Segmentation, Targeting and Positioning of Services, Customer profiling and segmentation for personalized services, Use of big data and predictive analytics in service personalization.<br><br>Pricing strategies in services- Factors involved in pricing a service product, pricing strategies for services. Revenue Management Strategies in services.<br><br>Integrated Service Marketing Communication- Advertising and sales promotion in services, Digital Marketing, Physical evidences in services- Importance of physical evidences in services, Tangibilizing through physical evidences, Branding Services, Integrating physical and digital touch points<br><br>Distribution in Services- Strategies and challenges in distribution of services. Methods of service delivery, Franchising, Digital-first service strategies (e.g., app-based and on-demand services), Growth of self-service kiosks, apps, and portals in various industries.<br><br>Blending online and offline service delivery to meet diverse customer needs.<br>Service Quality- Service quality models, measuring service quality, continuous quality improvement, Quality Model, Diagnosing Service Quality Failures, Service guarantee and service recovery. Use of advanced analytics in measuring service performance, Incorporating real-time feedback mechanisms.<br><br>Employees and customer's role in service delivery- Managing the service encounter, service encounter triad, managing customer expectations and attitude, contact person selection and training, monitoring and measuring customer satisfaction, Servicescape Model, Impacts of automation on customer satisfaction and service efficiency.<br><br>Customer Experience Management- Creating seamless omni-channel service experiences, Journey mapping for enhanced customer satisfaction, Leveraging Voice of Customer (VoC) programs for continuous improvement, the role of AI and chatbots in enhancing customer service experiences. Co-creating experiences with customers. |
| **8** | **Integrated Marketing Communication**<br><br>Importance of IMC, Introduction to IMC tools – Advertising, sales promotion, publicity, public relations, Personal Selling and event sponsorship. IMC Planning process - AIDA model, Hierarchy of effect model, Innovation adoption model, Information processing model, The Foote, Cone and Belding (FCB) Model.<br><br>Planning for Marketing Communication- Objectives and Budgeting for Promotional Programmes, Setting communication objectives, DAGMAR approach for setting ad objectives, Budgeting -Factors influencing Marketing communication budget, 5 Ms of Advertisement, Media Plan ,Advertising message, Types of appeals and execution styles.<br>Media planning and selection decisions- Meaning and Role of Media Planning, Steps in media planning, Developing and Implementing Media Strategies.Print and outdoor media, Newspapers, Magazines, Out-of-home Advertising, Directory Advertising, Broadcast and Internet Media, Radio, Television and Internet Advertising, Email Advertising.<br><br>Public Relations, Publicity and Corporate Advertising- Definition of Public Relations, Publicity and Corporate Advertising, Difference between public relations and advertising.<br><br>Digital Media &Artificial Intelligence in Advertising- Evolution and convergence of digital media, E-commerce and digital media strategies, Social media advertising, Mobile advertising, AI and Automation in IMC, Chatbots and virtual assistants in customer interaction. Automation tools for email marketing and social media campaigns, Role of immersive experiences (e.g., AR/VR).<br><br>Evaluation of Advertising - Evaluating Advertising Effectiveness through Pre-tests, Post-test, Recognition Test, Recall Test.<br><br>Advertising Laws &Ethics- Overview of advertising laws and ethical considerations, intellectual property rights, role of ASCI. consumer privacy concerns in digital campaigns. |

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| 9 | **Retail management and Distribution:**<br><br>Overview of Retailing- Evolution of Retail Management, Types of Retail Formats, Functions of retailers, Multichannel Vs Omnichannel Retailing<br><br>Retail Store Operations and Design- Store Layout and Visual Merchandising, Technology in Store Operations, CRM in Retail, Retail Space Optimization, Retail inventory management<br><br>Retail Analytics and Technologies- Role of AI and Machine Learning in Retail Analytics, Predictive Analytics for Sales and Demand Forecasting, RFID Technology, Data-Driven Retail Strategies<br><br>Distribution Management- Introduction to Distribution Management, Importance of Distribution Channels in Marketing, Types of Distribution Channels (Direct, Indirect, Hybrid), Channel Design and Selection, Role of Distribution in Customer Experience<br><br>Supply Chain and Logistics Management- Domestic and international Supply Chain Trends, Inventory Management and Warehousing, Role of AI, Blockchain, and IoT in Supply Chain<br><br>Emerging Trends in Distribution Management- Sustainability in Distribution (Green Supply Chains), Subscription Models and On-Demand Distribution, Future of Distribution with Autonomous Vehicles and Drones |
| 10 | **B2B Marketing**<br><br>Fundamentals of B2B Marketing- Definition and Scope of B2B Marketing, Difference Between B2B and B2C Marketing, B2B Buying Process, Key Trends in B2B Marketing<br><br>B2B Market Segmentation and Targeting- Segmentation Criteria in B2B Markets, Key account management, Identifying Key Decision Makers and Influencers, Customer Lifetime Value in B2B Markets<br><br>B2B Product and Pricing Strategies- Product Development and Customization in B2B Markets, Managing Complex Products and Services, Pricing Models in B2B<br><br>B2B Sales and Relationship Management- Understanding the Sales Funnel in B2B Marketing, Lead Generation, CRM & Building Long-Term Partnerships<br><br>B2B Branding and Communication- Importance of Branding in B2B Markets, Brand Positioning and Value Proposition<br><br>B2B Digital Marketing Strategies: Role of Content Marketing, Social Media, Email Marketing Automation, Search Engine Optimization (SEO) in B2B, Role of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in B2B Marketing, Predictive Analytics for B2B Lead Scoring<br><br>B2B Distribution and Channel Management- Direct and Indirect Sales Channels, E-commerce Platforms for B2B, Managing Global Distribution Channels |
| 11 | **International marketing**<br><br>Introduction to International Marketing- Definition, Scope, and Importance of International Marketing, International vs. Domestic Marketing, Current Trends in Global Trade, Cultural and Social Influences on International Marketing<br><br>Global Market Entry Strategies- Exporting, Licensing, Franchising, Joint Ventures, and Direct Investments, Digital Exporting and E-commerce in International Markets, Risk Analysis and Legal Considerations in International Markets, Government Regulations and Trade Barriers<br><br>International Market Research and Data Analytics- Importance of Market Research in International Marketing, Technology Integration, Use of AI-driven Market Research Tools<br><br>International marketing strategies-International Product, Pricing and Distribution Strategies, |

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| | Impact of Digital Platforms on Distribution Channels, International Supply Chain, International Marketing Communication, Branding and Positioning in International market.<br><br>Legal, Ethical, and Sustainability Issues in International Marketing-International Trade Laws and Regulations, Ethical Issues in Global Marketing, Sustainability in International Marketing, Green Marketing and Ethical Consumerism |
| **12** | **Rural Marketing**<br><br>Understanding Rural Markets- Definition and Scope of Rural Marketing, Characteristics of Rural Markets in India, Digital Inclusion in Rural Markets, Sustainable and Ethical Rural Marketing<br><br>Rural Consumer Behavior- Understanding the Rural Consumer Mindset, Cultural, Social, and Psychological Factors Influencing Rural Consumers, Buying Decision Process in Rural Markets, Media Consumption Patterns in Rural Areas<br><br>Rural Marketing Strategies- Product and Pricing Strategies for Rural Markets, Distribution Channels in Rural Areas, Promotion Strategies in Rural Markets, Use of Traditional and Digital Media in Rural Campaigns, Role of Self-Help Groups (SHGs) and NGOs in Rural Marketing<br><br>Rural Distribution and Logistics- Challenges in Rural Distribution, Role of Technology in Supply Chain and Logistics, Rural E-commerce Platforms<br><br>Role of Agri-Business in Rural Marketing- Agriculture and Allied Sectors as a Key Market, Agri-Tech Innovations, Start-ups in Rural Agri-Business, Government Policies and Schemes for Rural Development |
| **13** | **Digital marketing**<br><br>Fundamentals of Digital Marketing- Introduction to Digital Marketing, Evolution of Digital Marketing, Digital Consumer Behavior and Trends<br><br>Search Engine Optimization (SEO)- On-Page and Off-Page SEO Techniques, Keyword Research and Analysis, Role of AI in SEO<br><br>Pay-Per-Click (PPC) Advertising- Google Ads and Search Engine Marketing, Display Advertising and Retargeting, Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO)<br><br>Social Media Marketing (SMM)- Role of social media in Digital Marketing, Social Media Content Planning, Social Media Analytics and Tools, Platform-Specific Strategies, Influencer Marketing<br><br>Content Marketing and Blogging- Content Strategy and Planning, Creating SEO-Optimized Content, Video Marketing Trends, Content Marketing Tools<br><br>Email Marketing and Automation- Crafting Effective Email Campaigns, Personalization and Segmentation, Email Automation Tools, Measuring Email Campaign Performance<br><br>Analytics and Performance Measurement- Google Analytics, Data-Driven Decision Making<br><br>Mobile Marketing- Mobile App Marketing Strategies, SMS and WhatsApp Marketing, Location-Based Marketing, Mobile Advertising Trends<br><br>Legal and Ethical Issues in Digital Marketing- Data Privacy Regulations, Ethical Marketing Practices, Cybersecurity in Digital Marketing |
| **14** | **Brand Management**<br><br>The Concept of a Brand- Definition and Characteristics, tangible and intangible elements, brand identity, Role of brands in creating emotional connections, Rise of personal brands, sustainability in branding.<br><br>Brand Life Cycle - Differences between product and brand life cycles, Types of research (qualitative, quantitative, analytics-driven) conducted at various stages of these cycles, predictive |

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| | analytics in managing life cycles, Integration of digital tools in brand management, data-driven branding.<br><br>Customer-Based Brand Equity- Definition and Importance: Building and sustaining brand equity from the consumer perspective, Sources of Brand Equity- Brand awareness, brand associations, perceived quality, and brand loyalty, Benefits of Brand Equity.<br><br>Choosing Brand Elements- Tactics for logos, slogans, symbols, and packaging, Brand Design- Developing brand essence, promise, and personality, Brand Architecture, Experiential branding,- leveraging social media, and using AR/VR for immersive brand experiences.<br><br>Brand name and brand extension - Strategies and considerations in naming. Brand Extensions: Advantages and disadvantages of brand extensions, Types of brand extensions and key influencing factors. Rebranding and Relaunching- Strategies for revitalizing a brand.<br><br>Brand Valuation- Concept and Financial Value of Brands- Importance of valuation in strategic decision-making. Valuation Methods- Cost-based, market-based, and potential earnings-based approaches. ESG (Environmental, Social, Governance) impact on brand valuation, AI-driven valuation models, and the role of NFTs and block chain in future brand value. |

**दिनांक – २१ जुलै, २०२५**

**अवर सचिव**
**महाराष्ट्र लोकसेवा आयोग**